

Socialistic Principles

These principles reflect the ideology of socialism. They lay down the framework of a democratic socialist state, aim at providing social and economic justice, and set the path towards welfare state. They direct the state:

1. To promote the welfare of the people by securing a social order permeated by justice—social, economic and political—and to minimise inequalities in income, status, facilities and opportunities[4] (Article 38).

2. To secure (a) the right to adequate means of livelihood for all citizens; (b) the equitable distribution of material resources of the community for the common good; (c) prevention of concentration of wealth and means of production; (d) equal pay for equal work for men and women; (e) preservation of the health and strength of workers and children against forcible abuse; and(f) opportunities for healthy development of children and protection of childhood and youth against exploitation and against moral and material abandonment[5] (Article 39).

3. To promote equal justice and to provide free legal aid to the poor[6] (Article 39A).

4. To secure the right to work, to education and to public assistance in cases of unemployment, old age, sickness and disablement (Article 41).

5. To make provision for just and humane conditions of work and maternity relief (Article 42).

6. To secure a living wage[7], a decent standard of life and social and cultural opportunities for all workers (Article 43).

7. To take steps to secure the participation of workers in the management of industries[8] (Article 43A).

8. To raise the level of nutrition and the standard of living of people and to improve public health (Article 47).



Gandhian Principles

These principles are based on Gandhian ideology. They represent the programme of reconstruction enunciated by Gandhi during the national movement. In order to fulfil the dreams of Gandhi, some of his ideas were included as Directive Principles. They require the State:

1. To organise village panchayats and endow them with necessary powers and authority to enable them to function as units of self-government (Article 40).

2. To promote cottage industries on an individual or co-operation basis in rural areas (Article 43).

3. To promote voluntary formation, autonomous functioning, democratic control and professional management of co-operative societies[8a] (Article 43B).

4. To promote the educational and economic interests of SCs, STs, and other weaker sections of the society and to protect them from social injustice and exploitation (Article 46).